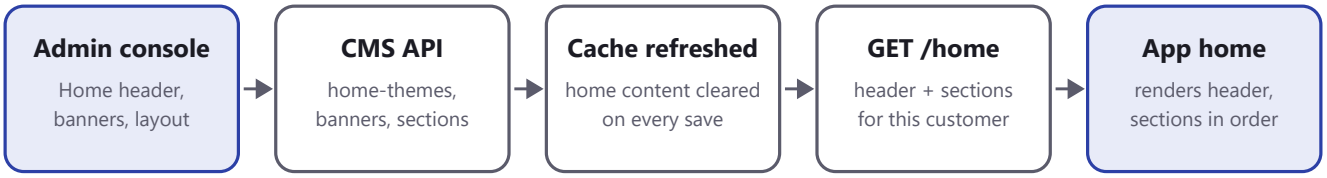
Meal Ji — Home & CMS changes

Everything that changed in the flow from sign-in to the home screen and the CMS that controls it: the app-facing API, the new seasonal header themes, the admin console, seed data, security and reliability fixes, Postman and tests.

Prepared 9 Oct 2026 for the app, backend and content teams. Backend: mealJiNode. Console: mealJiAdmin.



An edit in the console shows in the app on the next GET /home (the cache is cleared on save).

At a glance

Area	What changed	Who it affects
Home API	New **header** (seasonal theme), **deliverTo**, **serviceability.reason**, richer **cart**, veg filter, standard field names, cleaner banners	App developer
Header themes (new)	Scheduled themes: background, status bar, promo card with two side images. Default + dated (Halloween, Diwali)	Content team, app
CMS API	Theme CRUD; link, list and section validation; banner tracking limits; precomputed segment targeting	Backend, content team
Admin console	Content → Home header tab with live phone preview; every date field in IST	Content team
Seed data	3 themes (Halloween live now), new art, home layout in the app's order	Everyone testing
Security & reliability	Auth, OTP, redirects, rate limits, Redis reconnect, refresh tokens, staff login	Backend
Postman & tests	Theme folder with examples; npm run smoke:home (134 checks, all passing)	Backend, app

1. App-facing changes: GET /api/v1/home

One call still returns the whole home screen. New fields remove extra calls; old fields keep working.

New fields

Field	What it is
`header`	Seasonal header theme. `header.header`: backgroundColors, gradientAngle, backgroundImageUrl, statusBarStyle, statusBarColor, textColor, subTextColor. `header.promo`: title, badge, subtitle, ctaLabel, deepLink, couponCode, leftImageUrl, rightImageUrl, backgroundColors, titleColor, subtitleColor, ctaColor, ctaTextColor. A null promo means hide the card.
`deliverTo`	The "Deliver to" pill: label ("Home"), line ("Koramangala, Bengaluru"), city, addressId, source = address | location | point.
`serviceability.reason`	null when ordering is open; otherwise closed, paused, kitchen_unavailable, not_serviceable or no_location.
`cart` **(extended)**	subtotalPaise, freeDeliveryAbovePaise, amountToFreeDeliveryPaise (for "Add ₹X for free delivery"), amountToMinOrderPaise, fromOtherKitchen, updatedAt.

Behaviour changes

- `?veg=true` filters popular, usual, recommended and combos; without it the saved Veg toggle applies.
- latitude and longitude must be sent together or not at all (422 otherwise).
- With coordinates, home uses only that point. Outside the delivery area it returns serviceable: false with a reason and hides kitchen sections.
- Without coordinates, distance and ETA are measured from the customer's saved location or address (no longer 0 km from the kitchen).
- The header promo card now comes from `header.promo`; the old promo banner section was removed.
- Banners no longer carry admin fields (impressions, clicks, segmentId, cities, kitchenIds, isActive, sortOrder).
- "Your usual?" skips dishes that are not available. The default layout includes the features strip.
- Rate limit: 120 home calls per minute per account.

Standard field names (old names still sent for now)

Use this	Instead of	On
`name`	`title`	combos
`originalPricePaise`	`mrpPaise`	plans
`ratingAvg` + `ratingCount`	`rating`	dishes (kitchen ratingAvg now rounded to one decimal)
`servesCount`	`serves`	combos

Banner tracking

`POST /banners/:id/impression` and `/click` now return 404 for unknown or inactive banners, and count each person at most once per banner per day (a repeat call returns tracked: false).

2. Home header themes (new)

The coloured top of the home screen (background, status bar and the promo card with an image on each side) is now a scheduled CMS theme, so seasonal looks like Halloween or Diwali switch on and off by date without an app release.

How the live theme is chosen

- Only themes that are on, inside their date window, and targeted to the customer's city (or every city) compete.
- The highest priority wins; ties go to the most recent start. With none live, the default theme shows.
- There is exactly one default; it cannot be deleted (409). End dates are exclusive.

Admin endpoints (permission content.manage)

Endpoint	Purpose
`GET /admin/home-themes`	All themes with isLiveNow
`GET /admin/home-themes/:id`	One theme
`POST /admin/home-themes`	Create: name, priority, startsAt, endsAt, cities, header{…}, promo{…}
`PATCH /admin/home-themes/:id`	Edit, switch on/off, change dates
`DELETE /admin/home-themes/:id`	Delete (not the default)

Seeded themes

Meal Ji Indigo (default) Always, unless another theme is live. Today's header: indigo, Foodie Weekend, FOODIE150.		
Halloween: Spooky Bites From the day the seed runs until 1 Nov. Orange-to-purple, BOO badge, “GRAB A TREAT”, BOO131.		
Diwali: Festival of Lights 3 – 13 Nov, priority above Halloween. Amber-to-maroon, DIWALI100.		

Pumpkin, ghost, diya and gift are new flat illustrations in the app's sticker style (scripts/seed-assets/), hosted on the CDN. Replace them anytime from the editor.

Rendering in the app

- Gradient: react-native-linear-gradient; the angle follows CSS (180 = top to bottom). The background image, if any, sits on top (cover).
- Status bar: statusBarStyle light/dark → barStyle; statusBarColor → backgroundColor.
- Colours are #RRGGBB or #RRGGBBAA (the last two digits are opacity); React Native accepts both.
- Keep the current built-in header as a fallback for the rare case header is null.

3. CMS API behaviour

Rule	Detail
Links are safe	Banner deepLink, theme promo.deepLink and in-app message deepLink must start with mealji:// or https://. javascript:, data: and http: are rejected (422).
Lists are lists	cities and kitchenIds must be arrays; bad input is a 422, not a server error.
Features strip	Up to 6 items, each {icon slug, title ≤ 40, subtitle ≤ 60}.
Section limits	config.limit must be 1 – 20.
Immediate effect	Saving a banner, slide, layout or theme clears the shared home cache.
Segment targeting	Who is in each dynamic segment is precomputed when a segment is saved and every 15 minutes; home reads it with two indexed lookups. A banner aimed at Plus members shows only to Plus members (tested).

4. Admin console

- **Content → Home header** (new tab): theme list with Default / Live now / Scheduled / Off / Ended, on/off switch, edit and delete.
- **Theme editor**: name, schedule, priority, cities; header gradient colours and angle, background image, status bar, text colours; promo left/right images, title, badge, subtitle, button, coupon, link and colours; a live phone preview of the app header.
- **All dates in IST**: every date field (themes, banners, coupons, campaigns, in-app messages, settings) reads and writes India time, labelled "(IST)", whatever the admin's computer timezone.
- **Platform staff card** on the dashboard counts every platform role.

5. Security and reliability fixes (sign-in → home → CMS)

Fix	Before → after
Click redirect	/r/:id?to= redirected anywhere → only mealji:// and MealJi's own hosts (LINK_HOSTS adds more).
OTP lockout	20 wrong codes from anyone locked the real user out for a day → counted per device, plus a 5× per-account ceiling.
Staff login	Revealed whether a number is staff → same "OTP sent" answer for any number; decoys cannot sign in.
Token refresh	Two refreshes at once could log a device out → the second waits and receives the same new token.
Location lookups	Pincode check called Google every time, unlimited → 30-day cache, rate limits, one demand log per user/place/day.
Redis	Production stopped reconnecting after a blip → keeps reconnecting; /health/ready reports Redis.
Location save	Failed whenever Google failed → saves the pin as "Pinned location".
Other	Double-tap first login no longer errors; consent source cannot be faked; city aliases (Bangalore = Bengaluru); menu loaded once per home request.

6. Seed data

- Menu, banners, onboarding, combos, plans and About the chef mirror the customer app, with its own photos (51 images on the CDN).
- Home layout in the app's order: hero carousel, Today's Menu, Meal Combos, features, Your usual?, Meal Ji Plus, How we cook, Popular today.
- Header themes as listed in section 2; Halloween is live from the seed date so the app team sees it now.
- Demo customers' saved locations now include every required field (this caused the occasional “Validation failed” on the veg toggle).
- Run `npm run seed` (adds what's missing) or `npm run seed -- --fresh` (rebuilds demo data; backup in .seed-backups/).

7. Postman, docs and tests

- **Postman**: Admin · Content → Home header themes (list, get, create with a full Halloween body, preview now, turn off, delete) with saved example responses. App · Home → GET /home has an example with Halloween live. All 404 routes covered.
- **Integration guide** (shared doc): header theme rendering, field-name table, deliverTo, reason, cart and paging details.
- **npm run smoke:home**: 134 checks from app start to home and the CMS, including security and contract checks; it cleans up after itself. All pass (one warning: the Google Maps key needs the Places API).

8. Still open

Item	Owner
Enable the Places API on the Google Maps key (place search)	You (Google Cloud)
S3 bucket CORS rule so the console can upload images	You (shared bucket)
Rotate the AWS keys that were shared in chat	You
Premium plan card says 4 meals/day; plans support 3	Product decision
Remove old field aliases after the app moves to standard names	Backend, later
First git commit (nothing is committed yet)	Backend